humanitarian gestures this year would touch the heart of all Americans. Therefore, I conclude as you did, that a turn toward steady and good relations between our two countries is desirable and feasible and I am determined to do my part in working for that end.

Sincerely,
Ronald Reagan

At the end of the letter, I wrote a postscript by hand:

P.S. Mr. Chairman. In thinking through this letter, I have reflected at some length on the tragedy and scale of Soviet losses in warfare through the ages. Surely those losses, which are beyond description, must affect your thinking today. I want you to know that neither I nor the American people hold any offensive intentions toward the Soviet people. The truth of that statement is underwritten by the history of our restraint at the time when our virtual monopoly on strategic power provided the means for expansion had we so chosen. We did not then nor shall we now. Our common and urgent purpose must be the translation of this reality into a lasting reduction of tensions between us. I pledge to you my profound commitment to that goal.